CHARACTER FILM / 12 S / 16:9 / 24 FPS / LOOP

You know this intro.
Not this ending.

The studio logo starts exactly as you remember: the lamp hops in to squash the I. Then Clawd drops out of the sky onto its switch. Click. The lamp falls asleep, Clawd turns to camera and hops along the letters until PIXAR reads CLAWD. Eye beams, a flash, the end card. The lamp wakes up and storms off. The scene, the lamp rig and the sound were all written by Claude Opus 5.5 from the prompt on page 2.



12.0 s	24 fps	1440p	5 swaps	620	4
120 BPM, LOOPS	288 FRAMES	CYCLES, 384 SAMPLES	PIXAR TO CLAWD	WORDS OF PROMPT	FOLLOW-UPS



1.00 S
HOP-IN



3.04 S
CLICK



4.46 S
HEAD TURN



6.00 S
CLAXAR



8.25 S
EYE BEAMS



10.21 S
THE GLARE

THE FORMULA

01 Recognition first
Two seconds of the intro played straight. The twist only works if nobody doubts what they are watching.

02 Flip the famous beat
The lamp squashes the I in every film. Here it gets switched off mid-leap, and Clawd takes its beat.

03 Same letter count
PIXAR and CLAWD are both five letters: one hop per letter per beat, the name is literally replaced.

04 Keep the word in frame
The camera goes wide for the swaps. A transformation you only see half of is not a payoff.

05 A loser for the loop
The lamp storms off and hops back in on frame 1. People rewatch for the lamp.

06 Measure, don't guess
Exposure percentiles, the orange in RGB, loudness per quarter second, seconds per frame.

PAGE 02 **The prompt**, copy-ready.

PAGE 03 **Every follow-up**, in order.

PAGE 04 **Make it yours**, render it fast.

PAGE 05 **Every hit** on its frame.

PAGE 06 **Sound**, prompt and check.

The prompt

COPY-READY 620 WORDS

Paste it as is into Claude Code running Opus 5.5 at effort high, with Blender 5, Python (numpy, scipy, pedalboard, pillow) and ffmpeg installed. It models the letters from a font, rigs the lamp, animates everything in numpy, renders headless on the GPU and reads its own stills.

```
BRAND
HERO: Clawd, the Claude Code mascot as one smooth toy: body 12x8x6 units, two side nubs, four short legs, two black eye slits, soft rounded bevels, terracotta D97757, 0.26 m wide
BAND: a famous animation-studio logo intro: a black void, a seamless satin floor, five big white extruded letters P I X A R standing on it, and a balanced-arm desk lamp (round base, two pairs of rods with springs, a conical shade with a bulb) that hops in and is the only practical light. No real logo files: our own heavy grotesque (Archivo Black), our own lamp
RESULT: the letters become C L A W D in terracotta with "ANIMATION STUDIOS" under them; the lamp gets switched off, sleeps through it, wakes up and hops off in a huff
SET: letters 0.42 m tall, 0.16 m deep, rounded bevels; the lamp's head level with the letter tops; the floor fades to black 3.8 m out, no horizon

FORMAT: Blender 5 Python, Cycles GPU, 2560x1440 rendered, 1920x1080 delivered, 24 fps (film rate, like the original), 12.0 s = 288 frames at 120 BPM (one beat = 12 frames), loops through black. One timeline.py holds every hop, swap and sound event in seconds; the scene and the sound both read it.

BEATS (seconds):
0-2 the logo intro, played straight: the lamp hops in from frame right, four hops along the floor in front of the letters, stops by the X and tilts its shade up at the I, a little nod
2.5-3 the lamp crouches to leap onto the I; Clawd drops from above the frame (his shadow first) and lands exactly on the push switch on the back of its shade: click, the light dies, the filament glows down
3.2-4.5 switched off, the lamp falls asleep under his weight: the joints fold, the shade comes to rest on the floor, he rides it down; push in: he looks down, then a slow head turn to the lens, the lamp's own beat; it snores. Rigid joints only, never squash the metal
4.5-7 he hops along the letter tops, one per beat; each landing squashes the letter and it pops back as the next letter of CLAWD (P to C, I to L, X to A, A to W, R to D), the pop launches him to the next; the neighbours slide to the new spacing; a front flip onto the D
7.3-8.5 he sits on the D, his eyes light up into two beams, they sweep the floor from right to left across the word, then turn into the lens: a flash
8.5-9.3 the end card: "ANIMATION STUDIOS" fades in under the word, happy eyes (the beam already made the sleeping lamp stir at 7.95)
9-11.5 the lamp twitches awake, unfolds with a clank, switches itself back on with a sputter, turns and glares up at Clawd, then hops off frame right in a huff; Clawd watches it go
11.5-12 fade to black; the first frame starts the hop-in again

CAMERA: the original's framing: low (0.4 m), centred, 35-38 mm, a slow dolly; push to 43 mm on the head turn; pull wide so the whole word stays in frame during all five swaps (you have to see it change); hold wide on the card.

LOOK: feature-animation lighting: the lamp spot as the key with a soft pool, a soft key 42 degree spread, faint top and fill, cool rims; white plaster letters, enamel lamp with steel rods; 0.5 shutter blur, f/3.2-5.6, AgX; Clawd measures D97757 on the lit body; leaps under 2.6 m/s.

CHECKS: 24 half-res stills as two contact sheets first, measure exposure (p99, clipped %) and the orange, then two full-res frames timed, then the full render.
```

BRAND	**The block you swap.** HERO, BAND, RESULT, SET. The rest of the prompt only uses these names.
BAND	Describe the famous thing by its parts, not its name. Built from scratch, it reads instantly and copies nothing.
BEATS	Every hop changes a letter. The pop that finishes one swap is the launch into the next.
LOOK + CHECKS	The light spread, the measured orange and the stills before GPU time saved every re-render.

Every follow-up

4 ROUNDS

After each check I wrote what I saw and what to change, in order. These are the notes; the pictures below are the same frame before and after follow-ups 1 and 2.

FOLLOW-UP 1 / AFTER THE FIRST 24 STILLS

The floor reads as a grey studio with a horizon: fade its albedo from 0.15 at 1.1 m to black at 3.8 m and give the area lights a 42 to 60 degree spread. The word sits left in the opening: centre it, 38 mm. The lamp is shorter than the letters: scale it 1.32. During the swaps the camera crops the left letters: hold a wide 3.1 m, 35 mm, follow 0.12. The beams sweep right into nothing: start at +6 degrees, sweep to -60, end at -13 into the lens.

FOLLOW-UP 2 / AFTER THE SECOND 24 STILLS

The narrow spread concentrated the key: the letters burn to white with bloom and Clawd reads salmon. Key 210 to 55 W, top 45 to 12, fill 22 to 8. Now p99 231 in the opening, 0.00% clipped; Clawd 221, 119, 87 against D97757 (217, 119, 87); the CLAWD letters a touch brighter, albedo 0.41, 0.071, 0.027.

FOLLOW-UP 3 / THE FLASH, FRAMES 202 TO 207

End-on, the beam cones vanish and the flash is only a pink overexposure of everything. Eye emission +650 for 0.05 s at 8.5 s, beam gain +14, the exposure bump 1.5 to 0.9 stops: the eyes hit the lens like headlights, with a bloom and a reflection on the floor.

FOLLOW-UP 4 / AFTER THE FIRST CUT

The pancake is a scale squash on rigid metal: the rods and the shade smear into a disc and it reads as a broken render. Put a push switch on the back of the shade and land Clawd on it: click, lights out, and the lamp falls asleep under him on its joints alone (0.55 / 2.05 / -1.08 rad), breathes, stirs when the beam passes, wakes and hops off. No squash on anything made of metal.

FOLLOW-UP 1

Result: the opening reads as the logo intro; all five swaps are seen whole.

FOLLOW-UP 2

Result: feature-film contrast: white letters with shape, a black void, D97757 on the body.

FOLLOW-UP 3

Result: a real hit on the downbeat instead of a pink frame.

FOLLOW-UP 4

Result: a gag that reads in one frame, and a reason for the eye beams: he took the light.

FULL RENDER

Result: 288 frames, 2560x1440, Cycles 384 spp OptiX, RTX 4060 Laptop: ~25 s/frame, ~2 h total

FOLLOW-UPS 1 + 2 IN ONE PICTURE: 8.96 S, THE END CARD



Before: a grey studio floor, letters too hot, salmon instead of terracotta.



After: a black void, a satin floor, the word in D97757.

Make it yours

Only the BRAND block changes. Pick any intro everybody knows, describe it by its parts, and let the hero take it over. Below: the lamp rig on its own, and the end card as it lands.

```
BRAND (an example swap, not rendered)
HERO: the same
BAND: a famous film-studio intro: a night sky, clouds drifting past a tall golden title on a pedestal, searchlights sweeping; our own lettering, no logo files
RESULT: the searchlights catch Clawd climbing the title; every step he takes turns a letter terracotta until it reads his name
SET: the same rules: the title in frame for every swap, one swap per beat
```



The lamp: base with the engraved maker's mark, two arms of parallel rods with springs, bolts, a shade with a bulb. Every joint is one angle per frame.



The card: the word in 3D, "ANIMATION STUDIOS" as a 2D overlay that fades in on the flash.

Render it fast

1. Build the textures: `python build_assets.py` writes the maker's mark and the title card.
2. Build the .blend from scene.py with `blender -b --factory-startup -P scene.py`; it prints every jump in m/s, so a teleport shows up before the render.
3. Preview 24 stills at 50% and 40 samples (about 1 s each) and read them as contact sheets; measure p99 and the orange.
4. Pass `-P gpu.py` on every render: OptiX is a user preference, not part of the file. About 27 s a frame at 1440p and 384 samples on an RTX 4060 Laptop.
5. Encode H.264 High CRF 16, 24 fps, overlay the card, scale 1440p to 1080p with Lanczos, tag it BT.709 (untagged, players shift the orange), AAC 320k.

Every hit on its frame

Read straight from timeline.py; the frame is time x 24 + 1. At 120 BPM a beat is 12 frames, so every landing, swap and hit sits on a beat.

TIME	FRAME	PICTURE	SOUND
0.04 to 1.76 s	f2 to f43	the lamp hops in, four hops, stops by the X	pizzicato + celesta on each landing, spring sproings
1.88 to 2.40 s	f46 to f59	it tilts its shade up at the I, a nod	two celesta questions, a squeak
2.45 to 3.00 s	f60 to f73	it crouches; Clawd falls in from above	string tremolo, creak, slide whistle
3.00 s	f73	Clawd lands on the switch: click, lights out	the click, a power-down, then silence
3.16 to 3.92 s	f77 to f95	the lamp falls asleep under him, head to the floor	spring creak, a soft clunk, a snore
3.85 to 4.45 s	f93 to f108	the slow head turn to the lens	one celesta ding
5.0 / 5.5 / 6.0 / 6.5 / 7.0 s	f121 / 133 / 145 / 157 / 169	five landings: P to C, I to L, X to A, A to W, R to D	squish + bloop, a rising C D E F G
7.50 to 8.22 s	f181 to f198	he sits on the D, the eye beams sweep the floor	power-up whoom, hum, snare roll
8.50 s	f205	the beams hit the lens: flash	timpani, crash, F major brass and strings
8.55 s	f206	"ANIMATION STUDIOS" fades in	celesta arpeggio
9.45 to 9.85 s	f228 to f237	the lamp wakes and unfolds, switches back on	creak, sproing, clank, click, buzz
10.00 to 10.30 s	f241 to f248	it glares up at Clawd	a grumpy bassoon "hmph"
10.36 to 11.62 s	f250 to f280	it hops off frame right in a huff	squeaks, clanks, sad trombone
11.55 to 12.00 s	f278 to f289	fade to black, loop	fade

3 TIPS

1

Silence is a hit

After the click the music stops for 1.4 s; only a snore. The quiet makes the head turn land.

2

The pop is the launch

Each letter springs back and throws him to the next one: five swaps read as one motion.

3

Pitch the payoff

Each new letter plays the next note of a scale, so the ear hears the name being spelled.

Sound

COPY-READY 260 WORDS

The picture comes from the prompt on page 2; the sound came from this one more prompt, driven by the same timeline.py.

```
Add sound. Synthesize everything in Python with numpy, scipy and pedalboard: no samples, no words, no borrowed melody. 48 kHz stereo WAV, 12.0 s, read every event from timeline.py, land each hit on its frame and pan it by where it happens.

Music, F major: soft strings and a tiptoe pizzicato (Karplus-Strong) with a celesta note on every lamp landing; two questioning celesta notes as it looks at the I; string tremolo while it crouches. Everything stops dead on the click: 1.4 s of near silence with one snore, one celesta ding on the head turn. Then a bouncy 120 BPM pizzicato bed on F Dm Bb C7 with a shaker, every letter pop plays the next note of C D E F G, a snare roll and a cymbal swell under the eye beams, and the full hit on the flash: timpani, crash, F major brass and strings, a celesta arpeggio on the card. A sad trombone (C B Bb A, the last one wobbling) as the lamp hops off.

Effects: spring sproings and small clanks on the lamp hops, a slide whistle for the fall, a chunky push-switch click with a falling power-down hum, a spring creak as it folds asleep and a snore, boings and squishes and bloops on every letter, a power-up whoom and hum for the beams, creaks, a click and a sputter as it wakes, a grumpy bassoon "hmph" for the glare.

Master: headroom first, then a gentle compressor and a limiter at -1.5 dBFS; aim for about -14 LUFS.
```

The check I ran

SOUND FOLLOW-UP 1 / LOUDNESS PER QUARTER SECOND

The first mix measured -9.9 LUFS and the flash sat only 1.5 dB above the groove: the buses summed above 0 dBFS, so the limiter shaved about 10 dB off every hit. Normalize to -4.4 dBFS peak before the compressor, intro strings 0.45 to 0.16, timpani 1.4 to 0.6, celesta bus 0.8. Now the intro -19 dB, the silence with the snore -30, the groove -15, the flash -12. The switch click is a sharp transient: low-pass it at 7 kHz or its inter-sample peaks hit -0.4 dBFS. Final: -13.8 LUFS, true peak -2.4 dBFS.

Into the MP4: the WAV was muxed in as the video's AAC 320k track with ffmpeg; the same step works for your own video.